impl TopKMeasure for MaxDivergence

Tudor Cebere (@tudorcebere) Michael Shoemate (@Shoeboxam)

November 1, 2026

This proof resides in **"contrib"** because it has not completed the vetting process.

This document proves soundness of TopKMeasure for MaxDivergence in mod.rs at commit e62b0aa2 (outdated[1]).

1 Hoare Triple

Precondition

Compiler-verified

- Associated Const REPLACEMENT = false
- Method privacy_map
  Types consistent with pseudocode.

Caller-verified

- Method privacy_map
  - d_in is non-null and positive.
  - scale is non-null and positive.

Pseudocode

```
# MaxDivergence
REPLACEMENT = False


def privacy_map(d_in: f64, scale: f64) -> f64:
    return d_in.inf_div(scale)
```

Postcondition

Theorem 1.1. The implementation is consistent with the associated items in the TopKMeasure trait.

1. Method privacy_map: For any x, x' where $d_{\text{in}} \geq d_{\text{Range}}(x, x')$, return $d_{\text{out}} \geq D_{\text{self}}(f(x), f(x'))$, where $f(x) = \text{noisy_top_k}(x = x, k = 1, \text{scale} = \text{scale}, \text{replacement} = \text{Self :: REPLACEMENT})$.

Proof. Since Self::REPLACEMENT is false, then by the postcondition of noisy_top_k, noisy_top_k returns a sample from $\mathcal{M}_{PF}$. In the case that scores are not monotonic, by [1] Theorem 1, $\mathcal{M}_{PF}$ satisfies ϵ-DP, because the range distance is equal to $2 \cdot \Delta$. Otherwise in the case that scores are monotonic, by [1] Remark 1, $\mathcal{M}_{PF}$ satisfies $\epsilon/2$-DP, but the range distance is equal to Δ, thus satisfying ϵ-DP. □

[1] See new changes with git diff e62b0aa2..58a5519 rust/src/measurements/noisy_top_k/mod.rs

References

[1] Ryan McKenna and Daniel Sheldon. Permute-and-flip: A new mechanism for differentially private selection, 2020.